

the end will depend on the IPL's attitude." As host, Cricket South Africa reportedly received Rs 14 crore plus all expenses. Of this sum, eight staging associations were given an average hosting fee of Rs 57 lakh each.

Industry estimates now say the IPL will end up being worth Rs 1,200 crore this year, approximately the same as 2008. The real earners for the event is always television and here ratings have been lower, even if marginally so than Season 1 (see box).

The move to South Africa has spiralled on-air title sponsorship costs, which rose from Rs 20 crore last year to Rs 35 crore without an increase in title sponsors. Team sponsorships are down by almost 15 per cent from Rs 12-15 crore last year to Rs 10 crore. The economic downturn has sent associated sponsorships for the event into freefall from Rs 75 lakh to Rs 30-50 lakh.

Ad rates for TV have doubled from Rs 2 lakh to Rs 4 lakh for 10 seconds. Whether this increase and the marvellously cynical 10-minute 'strategy break' will enable Sony earn any money of the Rs 854 crore it has committed to this year on a renegotiated TV deal is not certain. Anirban Das Blah, CEO, Globosport, says, "The event will end up being more profitable for the BCCI, not the channel." He says, this was the year for the IPL to build year-long sustainability. "Although it's done well as an event, the euphoria is relegated to the here and now," say Blah.

Moving to South Africa, says commentator-columnist Harsha Bhogle, has made IPL a global brand. It worked in South Africa due to combination of big-name players, a viewer-friendly format and the allure of Bollywood's big names as part of the sideshow. "The biggest property in cricket, in our sport, is now an Indian property. That is huge," says Bhogle.

South Africa's Supersport2 TV channel ran the IPL matches all day, including pre- and post-game shows, promoting what it called the "red-hot IPL". An advertising budget of Rs 48

crore was spent on media in South Africa though one observer did say, "If you went out on the road, you would not know the IPL was happening. At a cricket ground, of course, it was completely different."

By going overseas the IPL also gave itself an inadvertent standards check: of how a global event is actually meant to run. To their surprise they found that even with three weeks notice, it was not last-minute, seat-of-pants stuff. That there is a benefit to putting systems and standards before personalities and perks.

Cassim Docrat, CEO of the Kwazulu

Natal Cricket Union says, "I think South Africa has been able to showcase the efficiency we have in running an event of this nature, the quality of our facilities and our ability to fulfill contractual obligations." Ahem. So, IPL 2 worked not only because of Lalit Modi's legendary ability to make offers people could not refuse but also because of the set-up that South African cricket had in place.

Delhi Daredevils coo Amrit Mathur says, "India always had the numbers and the money. But this year the standard has been raised, in terms of delivering quality, infra-



INDIA WATCHED THE IPL LONG DISTANCE

SEASON 2 REDUX

The ratings for IPL Season 2 are marginally lower and somewhat fewer women are watching it, but everything else about Season 2 on the box remains the same. Even the largest advertiser.

1 OUT OF SIGHT, A LITTLE OUT OF MIND

The average ratings for the first 35 matches for Season 2 was **4.15**. It was **4.73** for Season 1 for the same number of matches.

2 IT'S A GUY THING

Male viewers dominated the screen with **66** per cent. Women lagged behind at **34** per cent. Last year's figures were 64 per cent for men and 36 per cent for women.

3 THE OLDER, THE SPORTIER

Men over 35 formed the biggest segment at **24** per cent (Season 1 was 23 per cent) while men between 15 and 24 formed **19** per cent (up by 1 per cent from last year). Women over 35 were also big viewers, at **14** per cent this year and **15** per cent last year.

4 ZOOZOO WINS

Vodafone's enigmatic zoozoos made it the most advertised brand in the IPL this year occupying **11** per cent of the time. Last year, Vodafone's pug was the winner with **14** per cent.

Source: TAM